

Build vs. Convert: What Each Costs

Two paths to a home for Power Church — build a new church, or buy the old movie theater and convert it. Here's the cost of each, side by side, with every number sourced.

[← Project hub](#) [Full options brief](#) [3D sanctuary](#)

THE BOTTOM LINE

Two options, two numbers

OPTION 1 · BUILD NEW

A new metal-building church

\$4.7M – \$6.8M

+ land (not yet priced) · 32,000 sq ft, brand new

✓ Column-free by design

JOMA bid (Houston GC)	\$4.70M
-----------------------	---------

Target (Amarillo GC)	\$5.0–5.85M
----------------------	-------------

Caprock bid (local, full)	\$6.81M
---------------------------	---------

OPTION 2 · BUY & CONVERT

The former Amarillo Star theater

\$5.3M – \$10.3M

land included · 83,422 sq ft · open-room range ~\$6.5–8.5M

⚠ Columns cost \$0.3–3M to remove

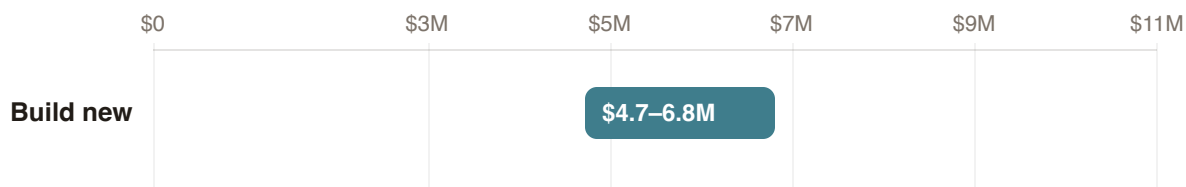
Buy the building (LOI)	\$3.80M
------------------------	---------

Renovation / fit-out	\$1.5–3.5M
----------------------	------------

Open the worship room (posts)	\$0–3.0M
-------------------------------	----------

SIDE BY SIDE

The same dollars, on one scale



+ land (not yet priced). Brand new, column-free.

Buy & convert

\$5.3–10.3 open room ~\$6.5–8.5M

Land included. The green band is the realistic range for a proper open worship room.

Read it like this: building new is the lower, tighter number — but add land. Converting is a wider range because of the columns: keep the posts and it's cheaper; cut them all out for a fully open room and it climbs toward the top. For an honest apples-to-apples (a column-free worship room either way), it's roughly **build ~\$5–6M + land** vs **convert ~\$6.5–8.5M, land included**.

WHAT THE MONEY BUYS

Beyond the price tag

	BUILD NEW	BUY & CONVERT
All-in cost	\$4.7–6.8M + land	\$5.3–10.3M (land in)
Square footage	~32,000 sf	83,422 sf
Open worship room	Built in, \$0 extra	\$0.3–3M to clear posts
Land & parking	Must buy / build	Included
Room to grow	Limited	~45,000 sf to spare
Condition / risk	New — lowest risk	Old — foundation + retrofit risk
Time to open	~6–9 months	Months (can phase)

Neither is the automatic winner. Build new gives the cleanest open room for the money. Convert gives more than twice the building plus land, if the church wants the room to grow and can take on an older building.

THE RECEIPTS

Where every number comes from

NUMBER	SOURCE
Build new \$4.70M / \$5.0–5.85M / \$6.81M (32,000 sf metal building)	Power Church Construction Pricing Research , Apr 9 2026 — real contractor bids (JOMA, Caprock)
Buy the theater \$3.80M (LOI; listed \$5.5M), 83,422 sf	Three-Scenario Pro Forma , Building Committee, May 4 2026
Renovation / fit-out \$1.5–3.5M; column removal \$0.3–3M	Planning estimates (Class 5, –30%/+50%) — firm up with a GC walk-through + structural engineer
17 steel columns, 83,422 sf, ~12,100 sf sanctuary, ~1,850 seats	Original theater construction CAD (read via LibreDWG/ezdxf)

Prepared for the **Power Church Building Committee** · Pastor Manny De Los Santos · June 2026. Bid figures are from named contractors; estimates are labeled. Land for new construction and final renovation scope are still to be priced. Full detail + 3D models at the [project hub](#).